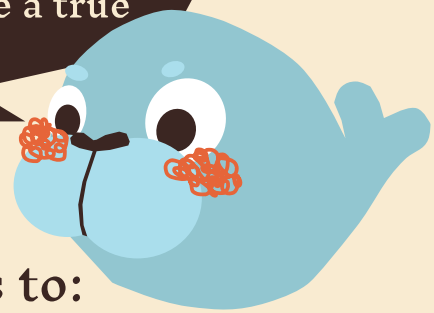
The Young Explorer's Journal

Coast Quest

Coastline adventure trails

Moikka Moi Explorer!

Welcome to your explorer's journal! My name is Bobs. I am a grey Seal and I live on the coast of Finland. I will help guide you throughout this journal and together we will discover what it takes to be a true explorer.



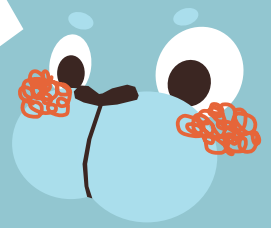
This journal belongs to:

Explorer _____

(your name)

Draw yourself as a costal explorer here!

first, to become a true explorer, one must sign pledge...



The Explorer's Pledge

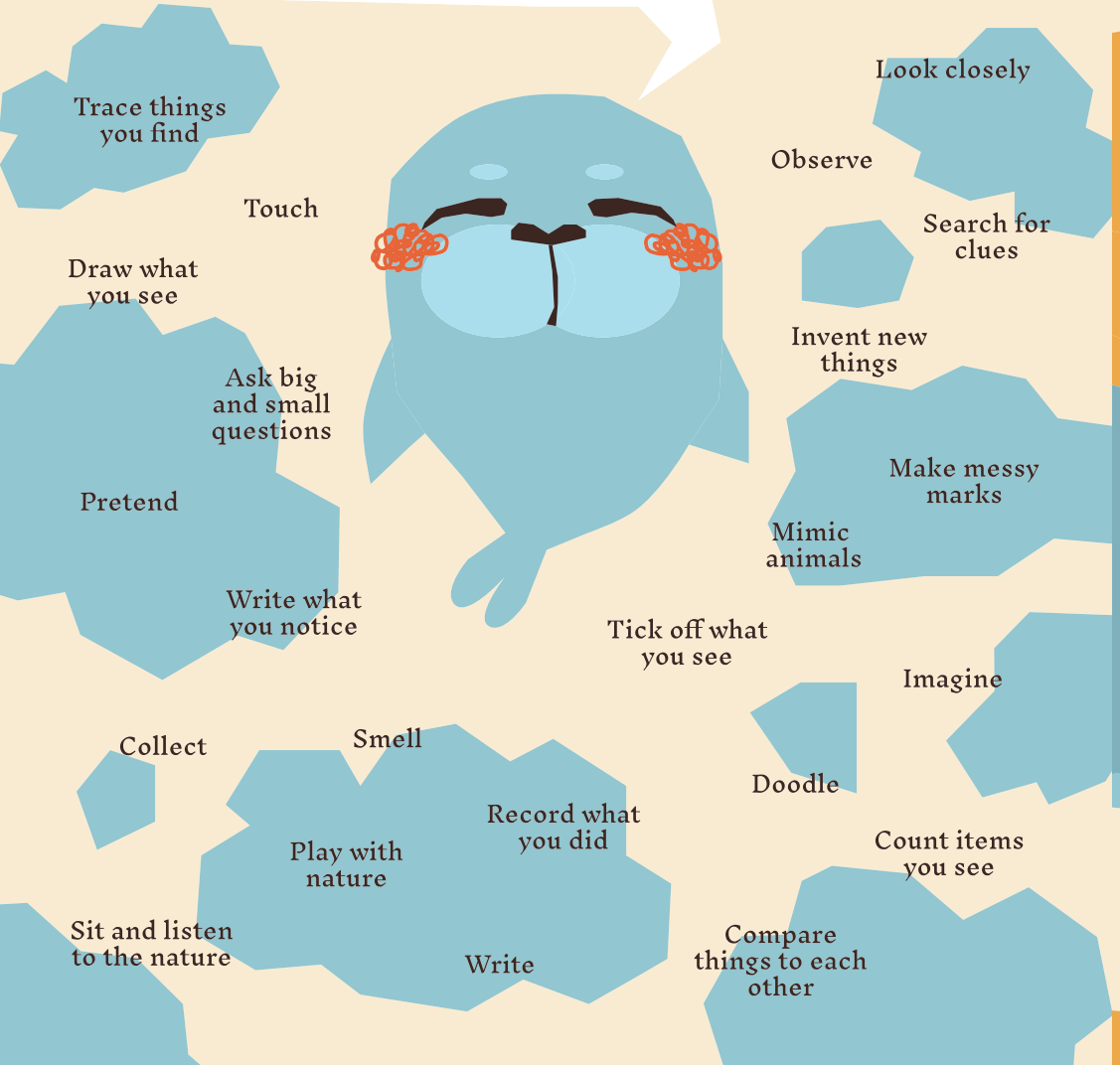
- I promise to explore with curious eyes and muddy shoes.
- I will look closely, ask questions and discover amazing things.
- I will be kind to the beach, the sea and all creatures that live there.
- I will leave shells for seaweed for fish and always take my rubbish home!
- And most importantly, I promise to have lots of fun while exploring!

Signed: _____

(your name)

How to use your explorer's journal

there is no right or wrong way to use your journal, but here are some ideas...



Important explorer's notes, scribbles and doodles go here!

Tides

The sea is always moving in and out. This movement is called the tide!

Look at the water, watch how it moves. Can you describe what is it doing?

circle

Based on what you see, will the water...

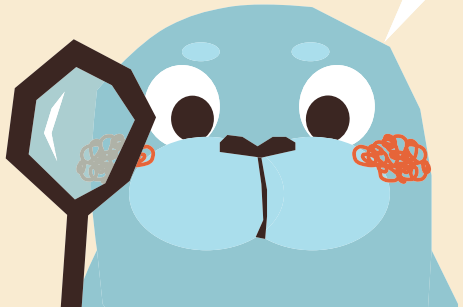
Move closer

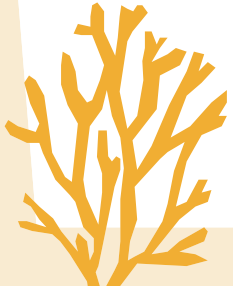
Move further away

Stay the same

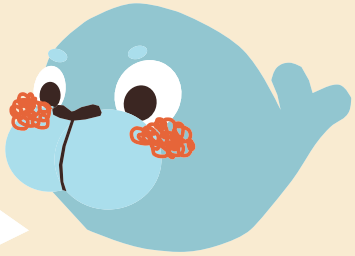
Look around you, can you find clues to tell us where the water could reach?

PSSST
Look at wet and dry sand, seaweed and rock erosion



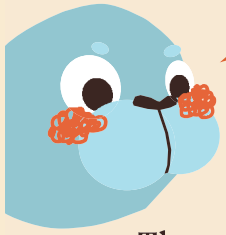


Wow, what a journey! I shore am impressed! I hope you had a whale of a time exploring!
You dove into discovery, stayed current, and showed true explorer spirit from start to fin!



I have just one last question...

Where will you explore next?



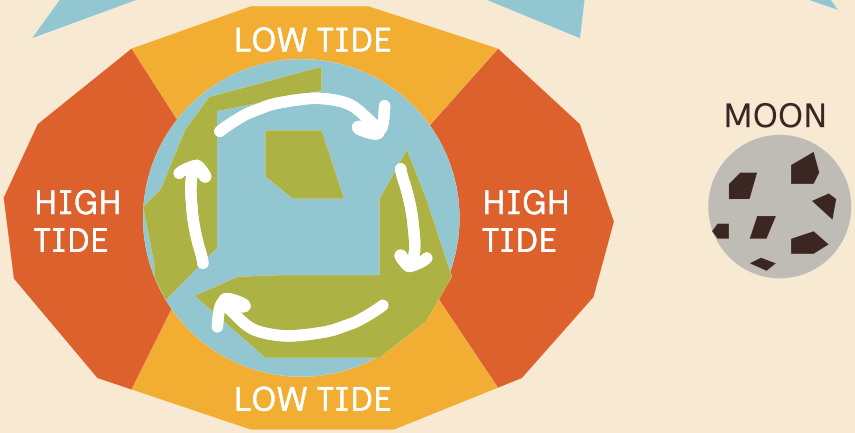
Fun Fact!
Tides are controlled by the moon

Tides

The moon pulls the ocean towards it with an invisible force called gravity.

This pull makes the water move and bulge towards the moon.

When this happens it creates a high tide!



At the same time, another high tide forms on the opposite side of the earth.

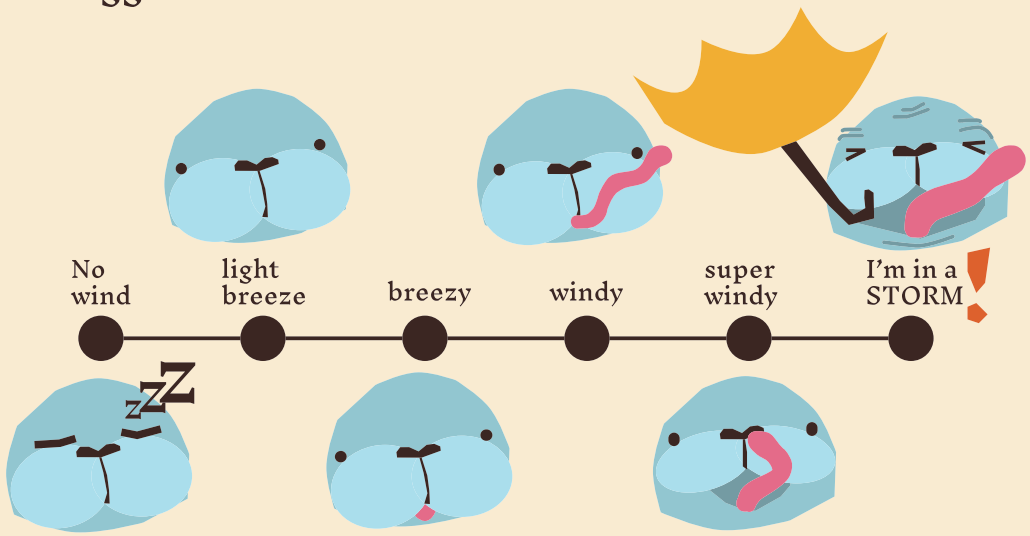
Planet earth is always spinning around, and when it spins, different zones enter this water bulge (high tide), and then spins out of it again (low tide).

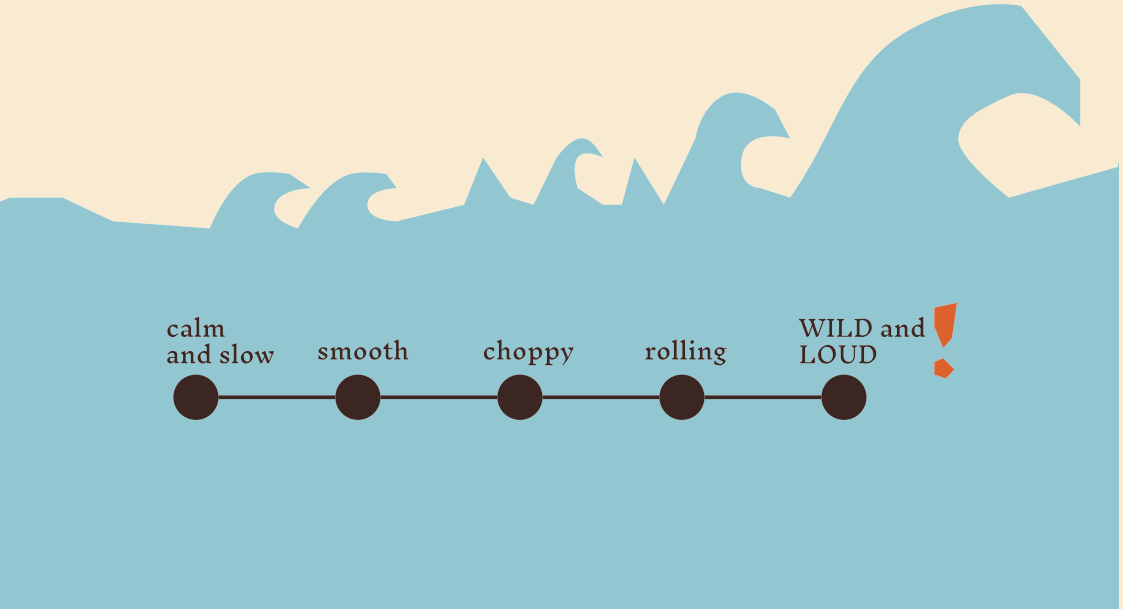
This is why we can see the tides rising and falling each day!

Waves

Waves are caused by wind blowing across the water. The stronger the wind the bigger the waves!

Some waves can travel across entire oceans! Storms far away can create waves that reach your beaches DAYS later!





A thing I hope to protect in the places I explored is:

The biggest challenge during my journey was:

A marine topic I want to learn more about is...

My favourite marine environment is:

My favourite thing about being an explorer is:

As an explorer I am great at:

The most exciting moment of my adventure was:

My Exploration Journey

(A short recap of the best bits!)

My favourite coastal location and why:

My favourite marine animal I saw:

My favourite thing I found:

Something I learnt that blew my mind:

My favourite day out exploring and what happened:

Waves

Watch the waves crash against the sand, count how many waves you can spot in 1 minute

Pretend the waves are controlling your hand, scribble the kind of motion it makes!

Explorer's Checklist:

Tides and Waves

D

The Captain

You enjoy discovering things with others. You like sharing, helping, and making sure everyone feels included.

Your strengths: Supportive, Good communicator, Natural leader

E

The Horizon Gaurdian

You connect deeply with nature by slowing down. You notice sounds, patterns, and feelings others might miss.

Your strengths: Thoughtful, Calm, Reflective, Attentive

F

The Treasure Seeker

You're always searching for something new or unusual. You look beyond the obvious and love finding hidden treasures.

Your strengths: Creativity, Inquisitive, Independent, Imaginative

Now for the big reveal....

(psssst you can have many of these traits at once!)

A
The Navigator

You like to understand how everything fits together.
You notice patterns: where the tide reaches, how the beach changes, and how land meets the sea.

Your strengths: Observant, Organised, Big-picture thinker, Good at planning

B
The Ocean Whisperer

You're curious about living things and how they survive.
You notice tiny details: shell patterns, seaweed shapes, and animal behaviour.

Your strengths: Curiosity, Patience, Detail-focused, Loves learning

C
The Storm Chaser

You're drawn to movement, energy, and excitement. You want to experience the ocean: getting close to waves, water, and action.

Your strengths: Bravery, Energetic, Curious through action, Loves challenges

- [ ] Observe the tide coming in
- [ ] Observe the tide going out
- [ ] Predict where the tide will go next- then check!
- [ ] Find the high tide line
- [ ] Find seaweed left behind from the tide
- [ ] Find shells or driftwood left behind by the tide
- [ ] Observe calm, smooth, gentle waves
- [ ] Observe wild, loud, ferocious waves
- [ ] Notice how the wind controls the waves
- [ ] Listen to the sound of the waves as they crash
- [ ] Find a smooth stone that's been shaped by the waves
- [ ] Find sea foam, left behind by waves
- [ ] Find cool patterns in the sand made by waves
- [ ] See a full moon at high tide
- [ ] Try to be as close to the shoreline without the waves catching you
- [ ] Find the spot where wet and dry sand meet
- [ ] Decide what mood the ocean is in by observing it

What would you rather explore?
A. A long stretch of coastline
B. A detailed rock pool
C. Open water
D. A group expedition
E. A beach at sunset
F. A hidden cove

To you, what matters the most when exploring?
A. Understanding the place
B. Learning new things
C. Experiencing excitement
D. Sharing the journey
E. Connecting with nature
F. Discovering the unknown

What do you think is your greatest strength?
A. Precision
B. Curiosity
C. Courage
D. Leadership
E. Imagination
F. Creativity

A storm is approaching your ship. What do you do?
A. Carefully adjust course to avoid danger
B. Study the storm to understand it
C. Charge forward, this is exciting!
D. Check on your crew and keep everyone calm
E. Trust your instincts and feel the right path
F. Look for a new route no one has tried before

You arrive at a beach for the first time. What do you do first?

A. Walk along the shore to understand the landscape
B. Look closely at shells, seaweed and small details
C. Head straight for the water
D. Call others over to explore together
E. Sit and take in the sounds and atmosphere
F. Search for something unusual or different

You find a rock pool. What interests you most?

A. Noting where everything is located
B. Watching how creatures behave
C. Trying to gently catch something
D. Showing others what you've found
E. Observing patiently
F. Looking for rare or hidden species

What do you enjoy collecting most?

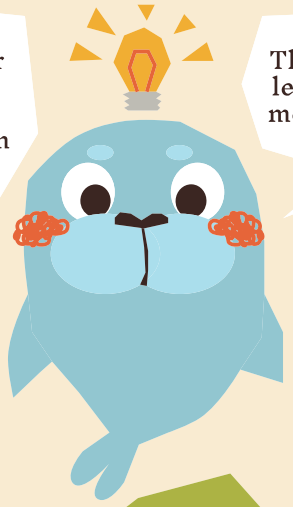
A. Maps or notes about where things are
B. Interesting facts or observations
C. Memories of exciting moments
D. Shared experiences with others
E. Special or meaningful objects
F. Strange or unusual finds

What part of the coast interests you most?

A. The changing shoreline
B. Plants and animals
C. Waves and water
D. People exploring together
E. Peaceful, uninterrupted natural spaces
F. Hidden or hard-to-reach places

The Baltic Sea

The Baltic Sea is super shallow compared to other seas and oceans. It has an average depth of 55m. Whereas some seas have an average depth of 4000m!



The Baltic Sea is one of the least salty on earth! Which means only special animals can live here.

FACTS

Very salty water is harder to freeze than less salty water.

Shallow water freezes faster and easier than deep water.

Finland has a northern climate, making it really cold in winter.

BRAIN WAVE CHALLENGE

Use the information above to solve the answer:

In wintertime, the Baltic sea _____

What kind of coastal explorer are you?

You have completed your exploration journey! Now take some time to reflect on it, and find out what kind of explorer you are!

For each question, circle one answer (A–F). At the end, count how many of each letter you picked... Your most common letter reveals your explorer type!

Hey Explorer! You did it!

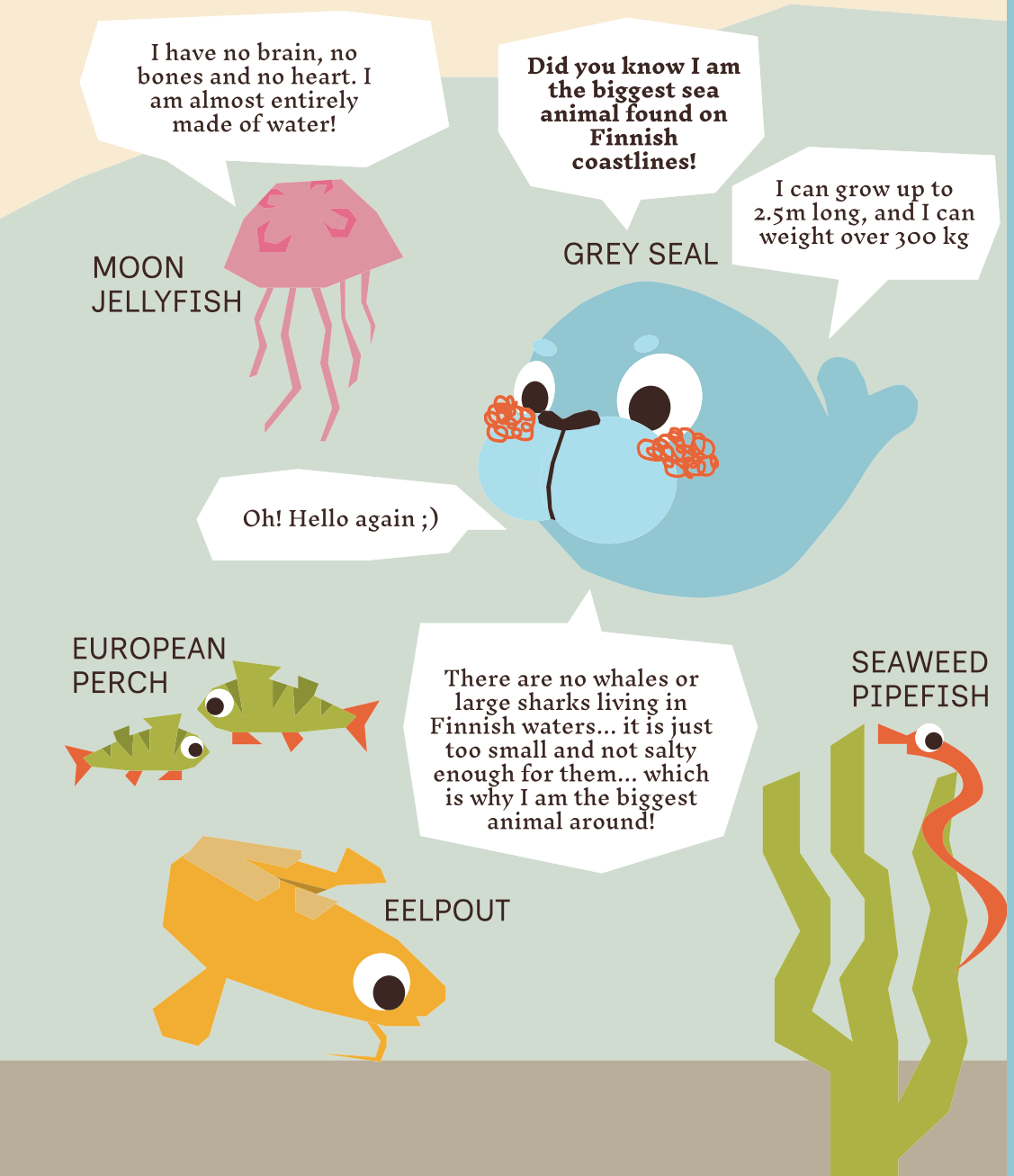
I've been watching your journey from the waves, and I'm so impressed. You explored, discovered, asked questions and learned how to care for our ocean home. That's exactly what a true Coast Quest explorer does!

You didn't just visit the coast, instead you noticed it, understood it, and became part of it!

Every rock you turned, every wave you watched, and every creature you learned about helps protect our sea.

Draw you favorite marine animal or invent one!

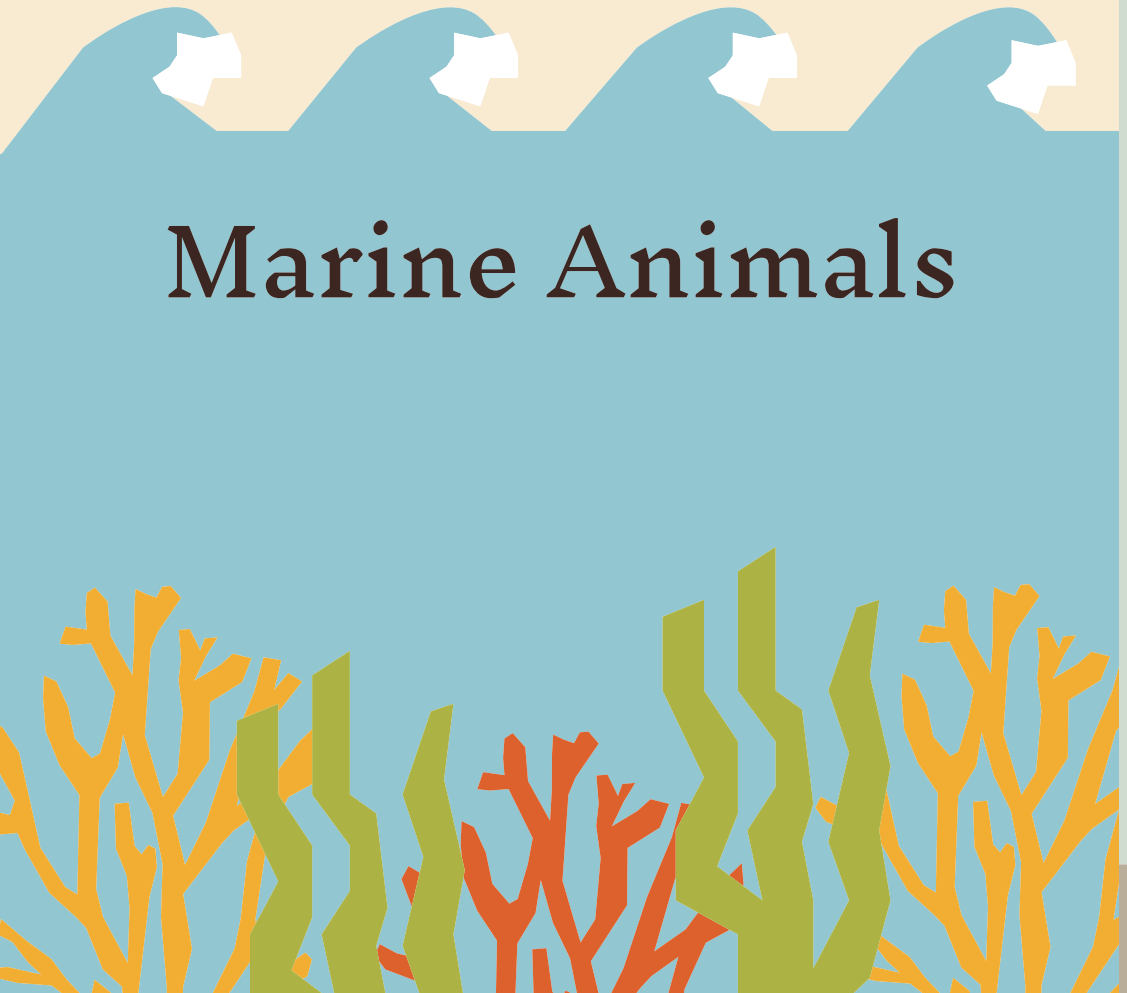
Finnish marine animals: underwater

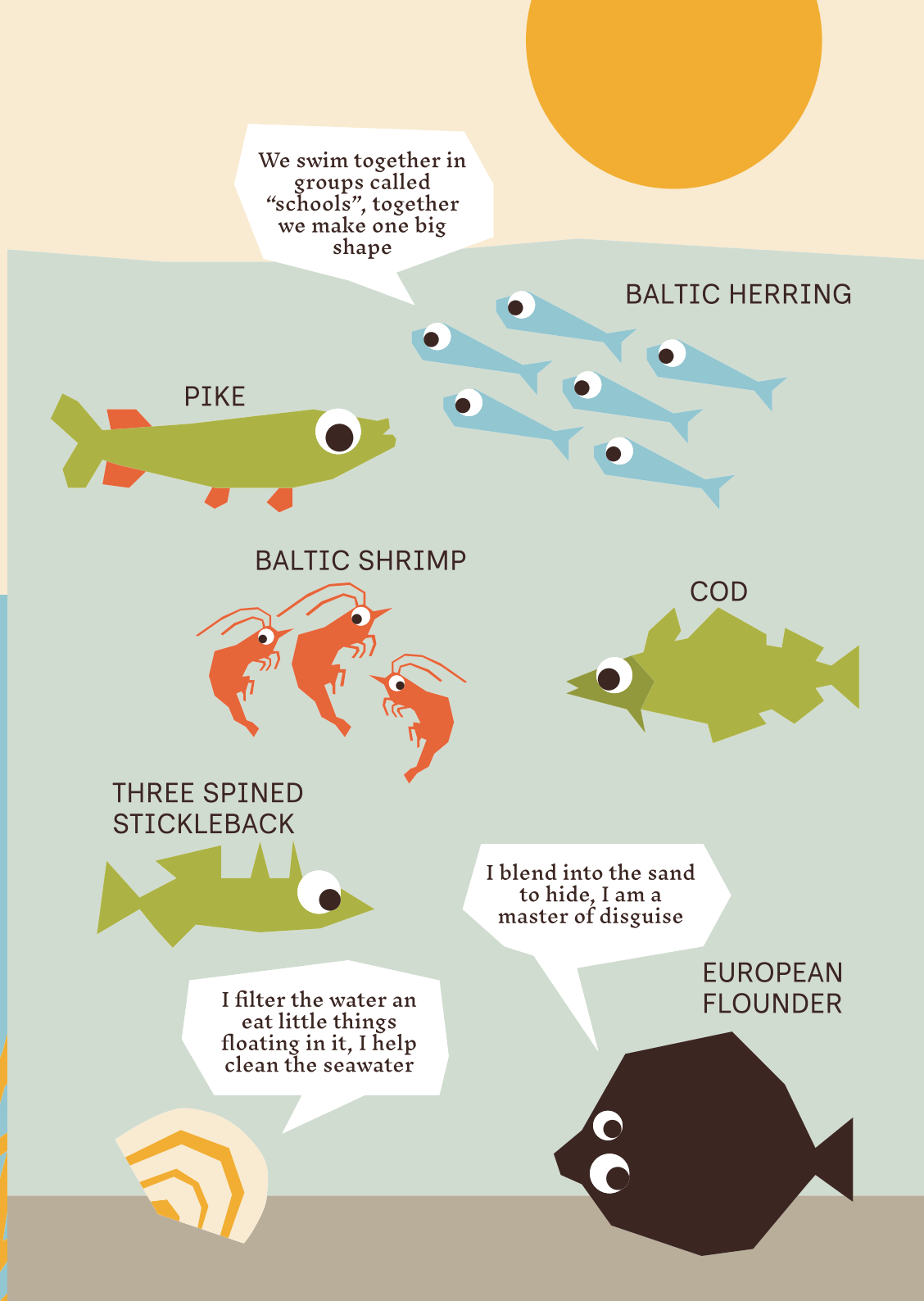


- [ ] Look for a seal's head popping up
- [ ] Watch how animals hide from you
- [ ] Notice which animals are fast or slow
- [ ] Look for the smallest creature you can find
- [ ] Look for birds gathering where fish are
- [ ] Spot a group of birds flying together
- [ ] Look for birds gathering where fish are
- [ ] Spot a group of birds flying together
- [ ] Spot a jellyfish floating in the water
- [ ] Find a crab hiding under a rock
- [ ] Watch how a crab moves sideways
- [ ] Look for tiny creatures under stones
- [ ] Find small holes in the sand made by animals
- [ ] Look for animals hiding in seaweed
- [ ] Spot a fish jumping out of the water
- [ ] Watch a bird dive into the water for food
- [ ] Find a feather on the beach
- [ ] Find footprints left by birds or animals
- [ ] Find an animal you didnt expect to see

Explorer's Checklist:

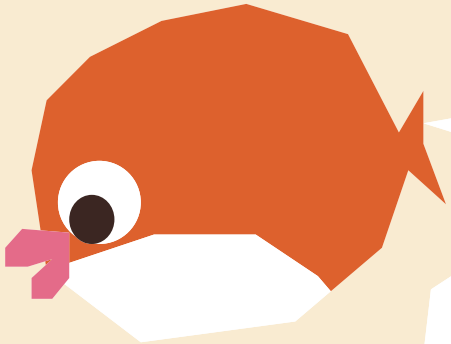
Marine Animals





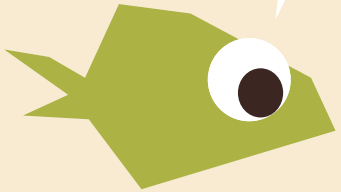
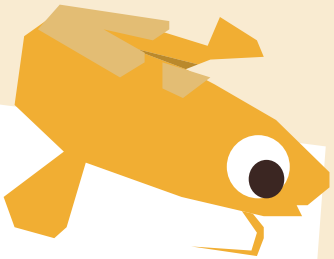
Draw adaptations

Animals adapt physically or behaviorally to survive ocean environments. For example:



Give me some spikes, so I can defend myself from predators!

Make me longer so I can swim faster!



Add me some stripes, so I can hide in the vegetation!!